December, after a lengthy debate, the following resolution was carried without a division

1 This Council opposes the separation of Burma from India on the basis of the Constitution for a separated Burma as outlined in the statement of the Prime Minister at the Burma Round Table Conference on January 12th, 1932
2 This Council emphatically opposes the unconditional and permanent federation of Burma with India
3 This Council will continue to oppose the separation of Burma from India until Burma is granted a Constitution on certain terms (as defined in the amendment)

In the alternative, the Council proposes that Burma shall ente the Indian Federation on certain terms and conditions including the right of secession

4. The Council urges that a conference be called at an early date for the purpose of determining the future Constitution of Burma as a separate unit on the basis defined or as a unit in the Indian Federation according to the terms defined with right to secede

(Clauses three and four were the amendments incorporated in the resolution)

The Government, however, interpreted this resolution as a vote not given for unqualified federation with India and they maintained that conditional federation, i.e., federation with the right to secede, was not possible The present policy of the Government is to separate Burma from India, and in accordance with that policy, Burma was not invited to send members to the third session of the Round Table Conference in November-December 1932

Towards the end of November a very important matter came up for consideration before the Indian Legislative Assembly—the Ottawa Agreement This Agreement had been entered into by the nominees of the Government of India who had attended the Imperial Economic Conference at Ottawa, in Canada, in August 1932 The purpose of the Agreement was to force on India a scheme of Empire preference whereby India was to give to Great Britain preferences covering no less than twenty-six per cent of her imports There was considerable agitation in the country against the ratification of the Ottawa Agreement In the absence